SADC HUMANITARIAN AND EMERGENCY OPERATIONS CENTRE

TRAINING MANUAL

Human Resources and Administration

Recruitment & Mobilisation | Welfare & Duty of Care | MHPSS | Learning & Development | Performance | Administration

Based on SOP Volume 5, Version 3.0 (Consolidated Compendium) — January 2026

Classification:	CONFIDENTIAL
Version:	1.0
Effective Date:	April 2026
SOP Reference:	Volume 5, v3.0 (SOPs 5.1–5.6)
Annexes:	48 Operational Templates (5.1-A to 5.6-J)
Target Audience:	HR Officers, ERT Coordinators, Welfare Officers, MHPSS Specialists, Managers

Benchmarked: UNDAC 8th Ed. | IFRC Surge Toolbox | AUC-DREA | WHO Staff Health | Sphere | ISO 22301 | ISO 15489

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1. Introduction and Purpose

This Training Manual is a companion document to the SHOC Human Resources and Administration Consolidated SOP Compendium, Version 3.0. It provides HR Officers, ERT Coordinators, Welfare Officers, MHPSS Specialists, and line managers with practical, SOP-by-SOP guidance on the six interconnected HR procedures that support the full ERT operational cycle.

The six SOPs cover: **SOP 5.1 (Staff Recruitment and Mobilisation), SOP 5.2 (Staff Welfare and Duty of Care), SOP 5.3 (Mental Health and Psychosocial Support), SOP 5.4 (Learning and Development), SOP 5.5 (Performance Management), and SOP 5.6 (General Administration).**

Core principle: Duty of Care precedes mobilisation — medical clearance, insurance, and MHPSS readiness are required before deployment. No personnel deploy without welfare verification complete.

2. Terms and Abbreviations

Abbreviation	Full Form
AAR	After-Action Review
BCM	Business Continuity Management
CISM	Critical Incident Stress Management
DSA	Daily Subsistence Allowance
ERT	Emergency Response Team
HRIS	Human Resource Information System (Azure Cloud)
IDP	Individual Development Plan
MHPSS	Mental Health and Psychosocial Support
NDMA	National Disaster Management Authority
PFA	Psychological First Aid
PIP	Performance Improvement Plan
R&R	Rest and Recuperation
SHOC	SADC Humanitarian and Emergency Operations Centre
SIMEX	Simulation Exercise
TNA	Training Needs Assessment

3. How to Use This Manual

All six SOPs map to the ERT Operational Cycle. Each section provides: SOP Purpose, Key Tasks by phase, Annex Toolkit, and Trainer's Notes.

3.1 ERT Operational Cycle for HR

Cycle Phase	Alignment	HR Focus	Timeframe
Preparedness	Pre-Mission (Be Aware)	Roster building; competency verification; training; medical screening; welfare kits	Continuous
Alert	Pre-Mission (M1)	Roster verification; availability confirmation; medical/insurance check	≤6 hours
Standby	Pre-Mission (M2)	Team composition; contracts; pre-deployment briefing; PPE; travel	≤24 hours
Dispatch	On-Mission (M3a)	Contract issuance; deployment; HRIS tracking; field welfare; daily monitoring	≤72 hours
Post-Mission	Mission-End	Demob; exit interviews; psych debrief; AAR; roster update; 30/90-day follow-up	≤2 weeks + follow-up

3.2 Dual HR System

Trainees must understand the distinction between Secretariat Staff (fixed-term, full competitive process, annual appraisal per SADC system) and ERT Surge Personnel (short-term ≤90 days, pre-qualified roster, rapid verification, post-mission AAR and roster update).

4. SOP 5.1: Staff Recruitment and Mobilisation

SOP Reference: Section 3 (Phases 1–4)

4.1 Procedures by Phase

Phase	Key Tasks	Annex
Preparedness	Workforce analysis; issue ERT registration call via NDMAs; credential verification; medical screening; training enrolment (SOP 5.4); HRIS entry with competency codes	5.1-A, 5.1-D, 5.1-H
Alert & Standby	Activation alert from Ops Centre; availability check (72hr confirm); team composition (skills, gender ≥45% female, regional balance); contract prep; pre-deployment briefing	5.1-C, 5.1-E
Dispatch	Head of Ops issues mobilisation order; contract issuance (≤90 days); insurance activation; travel booking; HRIS deployment update; on-site check-in with Field Lead	5.1-E
Post-Mission	Demob planning; handover checklist; exit interview; mandatory psych debrief (SOP 5.3, ≤7 days); AAR and roster update; competency profile refresh	5.1-F, 5.1-G

4.2 ERT Surge Roster Requirements

Minimum roster: 110 personnel — 20 Team Leaders, 40 Ops Officers, 30 Technical Specialists, 20 Support Staff. Eligibility: SADC citizen; 3+ years humanitarian experience; relevant qualification; fluent English or Portuguese; annual medical declaration; 72-hour deploy availability.

4.3 Trainer's Notes

Critical exercise: Simulate an Alert activation: require trainees to confirm availability of 15 roster members within 6 hours, compose a gender-balanced team with correct skills match, prepare draft contracts, and complete the pre-deployment briefing record — all within the 24-hour Standby window. Test whether trainees correctly apply the dual HR system distinctions.

5. SOP 5.2: Staff Welfare and Duty of Care

SOP Reference: Section 4 (Pre/During/Post-Deployment)

5.1 Five Duty of Care Domains

Domain	Components	Reference
Physical Health	Medical screening; vaccination; first aid; medevac; occupational health	WHO Staff Health; 5.2-E
Mental Health	MHPSS; stress management; peer support; PFA; debriefing	SOP 5.3
Safety & Security	Risk assessment; PPE; security briefing; incident reporting; evacuation	SOP 7.2
Living Conditions	Accommodation; nutrition (2,100 kcal/day min); sanitation; rest; comms	Sphere Standards
Social Support	Family communication; peer networks; recognition; team cohesion; reintegration	IFRC Duty of Care

5.2 Key Procedures

Phase	Key Tasks	Timeline	Annex
Pre-Deployment	Verify medical fitness; activate insurance; MHPSS screening (SOP 5.3); welfare briefing; issue PPE; security briefing; family notification	2 weeks to 1 day prior	5.2-B, 5.2-E
During Deployment	Establish welfare unit (Day 1); daily welfare monitoring; enforce rest (min 8h/24h, 1 day off/7, max 12h shift); medical capability; peer support; weekly family comms	Continuous	5.2-C, 5.2-F
Post-Deployment	Medical assessment (≤3 days); mandatory psych debrief (≤7 days); welfare survey; R&R leave (≥5 days within 2 weeks); 30-day follow-up; 90-day final follow-up	3–90 days	5.2-G, 5.2-H

5.3 Medical Evacuation Levels

Level	Capability	Response	Authority
1	First aid; minor illness/injury; monitoring	Immediate	Medical Officer
2	Local medical facility; outpatient	≤4 hours	ERT Lead
3	Regional hospital; specialist inpatient	≤24 hours	Head of Operations
4	Medevac to home country/specialist centre	ASAP	Executive Director

6. SOP 5.3: Mental Health and Psychosocial Support

SOP Reference: Section 5 (Preparedness/Dispatch/Post-Mission)

The MHPSS continuum operates across all phases. Trainees must understand that MHPSS is not just a post-mission activity — it begins with pre-deployment screening and continues through 90-day follow-up.

Phase	Key Tasks	Timeline	Annex
Preparedness	Psychosocial screening and baseline profiles; PFA/stress management training (mandatory certification); map counsellors and facilities in host Member States	4–2 weeks before	5.3-B
Dispatch	Deploy MHPSS cell at field base (≤24hr); daily 10-min emotional well-being check-ins per shift; crisis counselling on-site or via tele-counselling; CISM protocol for critical incidents (≤24hr of incident)	Continuous	5.3-A, 5.3-C
Post-Mission	Structured trauma debrief in-person or VTC (≤7 days); reintegration counselling and peer mentoring (≤14 days); tele-referral to national MHPSS networks; quarterly MHPSS AAR report	7–90 days	5.3-D, 5.3-E

6.1 Trainer's Notes

Sensitive exercise: Simulate a critical incident during deployment (e.g. team member exposure to mass casualty event). Require trainees to activate the CISM protocol (Annex 5.3-C) within 24 hours, conduct a structured debrief, arrange crisis counselling, and document in HRIS. Test confidentiality protocols — MHPSS information is need-to-know only.

7. SOP 5.4: Learning and Development

SOP Reference: Section 6 (L&D Cycle)

7.1 ERT Competency Framework

Domain	Core Competencies	Level Required
Core Humanitarian	Humanitarian principles; Sphere; Protection; Do No Harm; AAP	All ERT
Emergency Operations	ICS/IMS; Assessment; Coordination; IM; Reporting	All ERT
Technical/Sector	WASH; Shelter; Health; Logistics; Protection; Food Security; Camp Mgmt	Specialists
Leadership	Team leadership; Communication; Stress management; Cultural awareness	Team Leads

7.2 Training and Certification

Category	Duration	Frequency
SHOC Induction & Orientation	3 days	On joining
Core Humanitarian (Sphere, Protection)	5 days	Annual
Emergency Operations (ICS, Assessment, IM)	5 days	Annual
ERT Certification Course + Simulation	10 days	Biennial
MHPSS (PFA, Peer Support, Self-Care)	3 days	Annual
Safety & Security (First Aid, Fire, Driving)	2–3 days	Annual

7.3 Simulation Programme

Tabletop Exercise (TTX): bi-annual, discussion-based. Functional Exercise: annual, specific functions. Full-Scale Simulation: biennial, multi-agency field. Drill: quarterly, specific procedures. All simulation outcomes feed into roster competency updates and SOP revisions.

8. SOP 5.5: Performance Management

SOP Reference: Section 7 (Performance Cycle)

8.1 Dual Performance System

Element	Secretariat Staff	ERT Surge Personnel
Cycle	Annual (Jan–Dec)	Per mission deployment
Planning	Annual Performance Agreement	Mission Terms of Reference
Monitoring	Quarterly check-ins; mid-year review	Daily/weekly during deployment
Appraisal	Annual performance appraisal	Post-Mission Performance Review
Appraiser	Direct supervisor	ERT Team Leader + Coordinator
HR Consequence	Contract renewal; increment; promotion	Roster status; future deployment priority

8.2 Rating Scale (5-Point)

Rating	Level	Description	Target %
5	Outstanding	Exceptional; consistently exceeds; role model	≤10%
4	Exceeds	Surpasses most requirements; high-quality	20–30%
3	Meets	Fully meets requirements; competent; reliable	40–50%
2	Partially Meets	Some objectives not met; improvement needed	10–15%
1	Does Not Meet	Significant shortfall; formal PIP required	≤5%

8.3 Performance Improvement Process

For ratings of 1 or 2: (1) Informal coaching → (2) Documented discussion (30 days) → (3) Formal PIP with SMART targets (60–90 days) → (4) Weekly monitoring → (5) PIP review. Outcomes: successful (close PIP), partial (extend 30 days), unsuccessful (refer to disciplinary process per SADC Staff Rules).

9. SOP 5.6: General Administration

SOP Reference: Section 8 (Eight Service Areas)

Area	Key Services	BCM
1. Correspondence	Incoming/outgoing mail; official letters; email management; classification	B7
2. Registry & Archives	Filing systems (8 categories); retention; archive storage; retrieval	B3
3. Governance Support	Board/Committee secretariat; ED office; protocol; agenda/minutes/action tracking	B8
4. Meeting Management	Scheduling; room booking; documentation; minutes; action follow-up	B7
5. Travel Admin	Travel requests (10 days prior); bookings; DSA advances; claims (≤7 days); settlement	B7
6. Facilities	Office space; utilities (backup power); cleaning; maintenance; safety; conference rooms	B5
7. Asset Admin	Non-ICT asset register; custody assignment; annual verification; movement; disposal	B3
8. Visitor Management	Reception; visitor registration; badge issuance; escort policy; VIP protocol	B7

9.1 Document Classification

PUBLIC (no restrictions) | INTERNAL (do not share externally without approval) | RESTRICTED (named distribution; secure storage) | CONFIDENTIAL (locked storage; need-to-know) | SECRET (ED approval; encrypted).

9.2 ERT Cycle Administrative Scaling

Preparedness: routine admin. Alert: verify readiness, pre-position supplies. Standby: fast-track travel, surge admin prep. Dispatch: 24/7 admin support, rapid travel and field documentation. Post-Mission: documentation completion, archive capture, lessons learned.

10. Risk Register and Business Continuity

10.1 Key HR Risks (BGYOR)

Risk	SOP	Inherent	Residual	Key Mitigation
Delayed recruitment/bureaucracy	5.1	Red 5	Orange 3	Pre-approved roster; delegated authority
Staff fatigue/burnout	5.2	Red 5	Yellow 2	Enforced rest; rotation; MHPSS
Psychological stress/trauma	5.2/5.3	Red 5	Yellow 2	MHPSS per SOP 5.3; peer support
Insufficient MHPSS capacity	5.3	Red 5	Yellow 3	Regional MHPSS pool; partnerships
Skills gap at deployment	5.4	Red 5	Green 2	Mandatory ERT certification; simulation
Loss of critical documents	5.6	Red 5	Green 1	Backup; cloud storage; vital records
Data loss in HRIS	All	Orange 4	Blue 1	Azure redundancy; backup protocols

10.2 Business Continuity (B1–B8)

B1 Critical Functions: surge roster, field welfare, training coordinator designated critical. B2 MBCO: HRIS accessible, 30 roster personnel available, contract templates ready. B3 RTO: HR/welfare/admin restored within 4 hours. B5 Facilities: alternative workspace at Botswana OSOCC. B7 Cross-Organisational: NDMA HR liaison, SADC HR Division, partner surge. B8 Staff Continuity: ED succession to Head Ops; HR Officer backup; cross-training.

11. Annex Toolkit Quick Reference

Group	Key Annexes	Count
SOP 5.1 Recruitment & Mobilisation	Surge Roster Form, Recruitment Flowchart, Contract Template, Medical Declaration, Deployment Form, Demob Checklist, AAR Template, HRIS Standards	8
SOP 5.2 Welfare & Duty of Care	Welfare Flowchart, Pre-Deploy Checklist, Field Protocols, MHPSS Quick Ref, Medevac Procedures, Daily Monitoring, Recognition Certificate, Post-Deploy Survey, Contact Directory	9
SOP 5.3 MHPSS	Field MHPSS Flowchart, Stress Screening Template, Critical Incident Protocol, Reintegration Checklist, MHPSS AAR Template	5
SOP 5.4 Learning & Development	TNA Template, Competency Matrix, Training Calendar, Course Catalogue, Attendance Record, Certification Tracking, SIMEX Protocol, Post-Training Eval, IDP Template	9
SOP 5.5 Performance Management	PA Template, Performance Standards, Quarterly Check-In, Mid-Year Review, Annual Appraisal, Post-Mission Review, 360-Degree Feedback, PIP Template, Recognition Form	9
SOP 5.6 General Administration	Correspondence Register, Classification Guide, Meeting Template, Travel Form, Visitor Form, Asset Custody, Facilities Request, Filing Protocol, Admin Checklist, Governance Calendar	10

12. Monitoring, Evaluation and Learning Indicators

SOP	Indicator	Target
5.1	Deployment within 72h of Dispatch activation	100%
5.1	Gender balance in deployments	≥45% female
5.1	Roster size maintained	≥110 personnel
5.2	Pre-deployment briefing completed	100%
5.2	Insurance active before deployment	100%
5.2	Rest standards met	≥90%
5.2	30-day follow-up completed	100%
5.3	Post-mission debrief within 7 days	100%
5.4	Staff with current mandatory training	100%
5.4	Simulation exercises conducted	≥4/year
5.5	Performance agreements signed by 31 Jan	100%
5.5	ERT post-mission reviews within 14 days	100%
5.6	Correspondence processed within SLA	≥95%
5.6	Asset verification completed annually	100%

13. Assessment and Competency Verification

Competency	Assessment Method	Minimum Standard
ERT roster activation sequence	SIMEX: activate roster, compose team within 24hr	Gender-balanced team; all contracts prepared
Dual HR system application	Written test: classify 5 personnel scenarios	Correct system for all 5
Pre-deployment welfare checklist	Practical: complete Annex 5.2-B for a deployment	All 6 steps complete; no deployment without welfare clearance
MHPSS protocols (PFA, CISM)	Scenario: respond to critical incident	CISM activated within 24hr; debrief documented
Medical evacuation levels	Scenario: triage 3 medical situations	Correct medevac level and authority for each
Training needs assessment	Complete Annex 5.4-A from operational gap data	All 4 competency domains assessed; priorities identified
Performance appraisal (both systems)	Role-play: conduct annual and post-mission review	Correct rating scale; development plan produced
PIP process execution	Scenario: manage underperforming staff member	Correct 5-step sequence; SMART targets set
Administrative scaling (ERT cycle)	Scenario: scale admin from Preparedness to Dispatch	Correct services activated at each phase
Document classification	Written test: classify 5 documents	Correct classification and handling for all 5

Certification requirement: HR Officers and Welfare staff must demonstrate competency across all ten areas before assuming operational roles. Bi-annual SIMEX and annual joint drills provide the primary assessment vehicle. Results are recorded in the Staff Readiness Matrix (Annex 5.1-R equivalent) and reviewed by the Head of Operations.

— END OF TRAINING MANUAL —